

Assignment: Joy Oriented Literacy Pursuit

10 possible points (Last Revised Jan. 2026)

Objective:

Students will engage in joy-oriented literacy pursuit. They will create, share, and reflect on a literacy-based project that promotes liberation, self-determination, self-reliance, and self-empowerment, while experiencing the joy, love, and aesthetic fulfillment inherent in literacy practices.

Instructions:

Select, Create, and Share a Literacy Pursuit

- **Select:** Choose a literacy pursuit inspired by Muhammad's framework and aligned with your personal interests.
 - **Examples of Joy-Oriented Literacy Pursuits:**
 - Workshop
 - Performance
 - Cookbooks
 - Community Murals
 - Minecraft creations
 - Music playlists
 - Translations (can be a multi medium endeavor such as music and text)
 - Mapping projects
 - Poetry
- **Create:** Your literacy pursuit must represent an act of reading, writing, speaking, or art that embodies greater goals such as liberation, self-determination, and empowerment.
 - You can collaborate with others, remix existing content, and/or make your literacy pursuit participatory (have others engage in its creation). HITRECORD
- **Share:** The final product should be shared with an **authentic audience** (this may be in a classroom setting, on a YouTube channel, a social media platform, or submitted to a publication/blog) **and you have interacted with your audience's feedback.**

Reflect on the Experience

Write a 2 -4 page reflection (double spaced) or create an equivalent multimodal reflection (e.g., a presentation, video, or audio recording 5-7 min MAX) that addresses the following questions:

1. **Product:** What did you create, and who did you share it with? **(Provide links, attachments, pictures/ screenshots as appropriate.)**
2. **Process:** What was your creative and learning process? (Include resources used, steps taken, etc.)
3. **Specify:** How did your literacy pursuit cultivate joy, love, and/or aesthetic fulfillment for you?
4. **Connect to Text(s):** How did your creation exemplify Muhammad's ideas of a literacy pursuit? Did you connect the experience to any other course readings?
5. **Connect to Practice:** How might this experience inform your future teaching practice? How could you incorporate this or similar literacy pursuits into your classroom?

Samples of student work

Criteria	Exceeding Expectations	Meeting Expectations This column is full credit	Approaching Expectations	Below Expectations
Creativity & Depth of Literacy Pursuit 2	The literacy pursuit is highly creative, deeply engaging, and clearly embodies the goals of liberation, self-determination, and empowerment. The project demonstrates thoughtfulness and originality.	The literacy pursuit is creative and meets the goals of liberation, self-determination, and empowerment.	The literacy pursuit demonstrates some creativity but lacks depth or fails to fully embody the intended goals or the depth may be less fully developed.	The literacy pursuit is underdeveloped, lacks creativity, or does not align with the goals of liberation and empowerment.
Relevance to Muhammad's Framework 2	The literacy pursuit strongly aligns with Muhammad's framework of joy, love, and aesthetic fulfillment, demonstrating a deep understanding of course concepts.	The literacy pursuit aligns with Muhammad's framework and demonstrates a reasonable understanding of course concepts.	Some alignment with Muhammad's framework, though connections to course concepts may be unclear or underdeveloped.	Little or no connection to Muhammad's framework, with limited understanding of course concepts.
Audience Engagement & Sharing 2	The pursuit is effectively shared with an authentic audience, and the student engages the audience meaningfully (e.g., through social media, publication, etc.).	The pursuit is shared with an authentic audience, engagement with the audience is clearly articulated.	The pursuit is shared with an audience, but the effort lacks engagement or impact. Concept not thoroughly developed.	The pursuit is either not shared or shared without meaningful engagement with an audience.
Reflection on Process & Joy-Oriented Creation 2	The reflection thoughtfully and thoroughly addresses the creation process, detailing steps, resources, and the personal joy, love, and fulfillment experienced. Clear connections are made between the pursuit and personal growth.	The reflection adequately addresses the creation process and discusses the joy and fulfillment gained.	The reflection provides some insight into the process but lacks depth or fails to thoroughly explore the joy and fulfillment experienced.	The reflection is superficial, with minimal discussion of the creation process or joy gained from the literacy pursuit.
Connection to Texts & Teaching Practice 2	Strong connections are made between the literacy pursuit and Muhammad's ideas as well as other course texts. The reflection provides clear, insightful ideas for integrating similar literacy pursuits into future teaching practice.	The reflection makes clear connections to Muhammad's ideas and provides reasonable ideas for integrating literacy pursuits into future teaching practice.	Some connections are made between the literacy pursuit and Muhammad's framework, but ideas for classroom application are vague or underdeveloped.	Little or no connection to course texts, and minimal reflection on the pursuit's potential impact on future teaching practice.